

5. MMR is a safe and effective vaccine that protects against measles, mumps and rubella. These diseases are caused by viruses.



Photograph showing a child receiving MMR vaccine

- The full course of MMR vaccination requires two doses; a child has the first injection at the age of one year and the second at three years.
- If the child comes into contact with any of these viruses in the future, lymphocytes in the blood will rapidly cause the destruction of these viruses and the child will not become ill.
- A small number of children may get minor side effects due to the vaccine.

(a) Use this information and your own knowledge to complete the following table by writing **True** or **False** against each statement. [2]

Statement	True or False
Measles is caused by a bacterium.	False
The MMR vaccine is given as drops on the tongue.	
Most children do not get side effects.	
Lymphocytes are a type of white blood cell.	

(b) Predict what would happen to the number of cases of measles, mumps and rubella if fewer children were given the MMR vaccine. [1]

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